

# *Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.*

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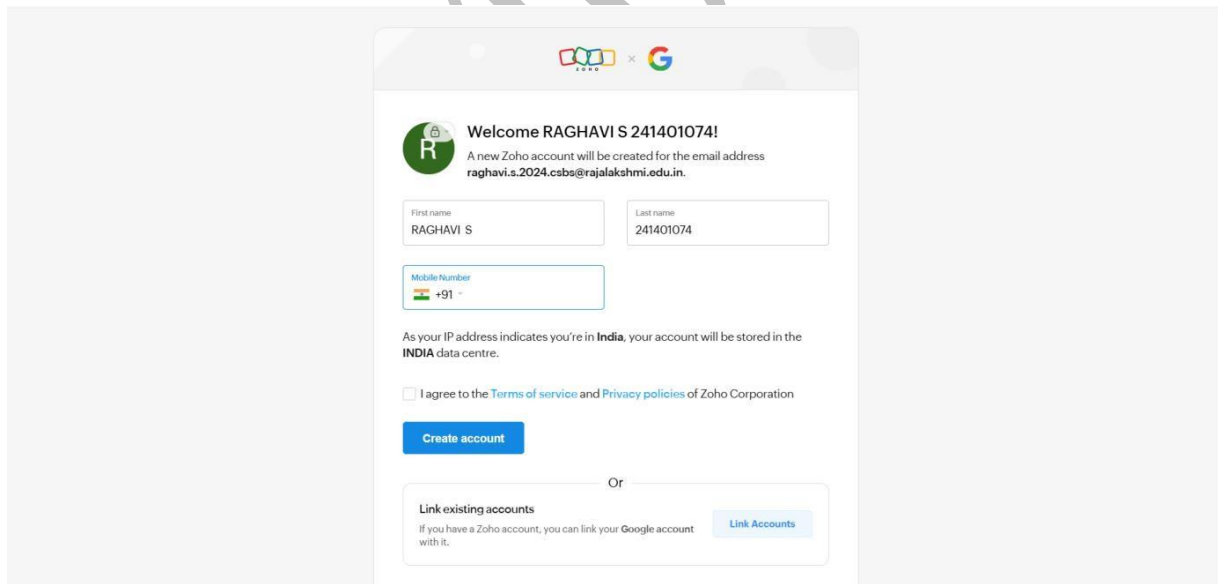
*Roll no : 241401074*

## **1.Introduction**

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based, low-code platform that allows users to create web and mobile applications with little programming knowledge. It provides an easy-to-use drag-and-drop interface along with features such as automation, database management, reporting, and workflow integration. The main purpose of this exploration was to understand the Zoho Creator interface, explore its important modules, and learn how these features help in developing applications.

## **2.Account Creation**

The exploration started by creating a Zoho Creator account using the college Google account. During the registration process, basic details such as the name, email address, and mobile number were provided. After accepting the terms and conditions, the account was successfully created, and the Zoho Creator dashboard became accessible. The account was activated with a 15-day trial plan, which provided access to most of the platform's main features.



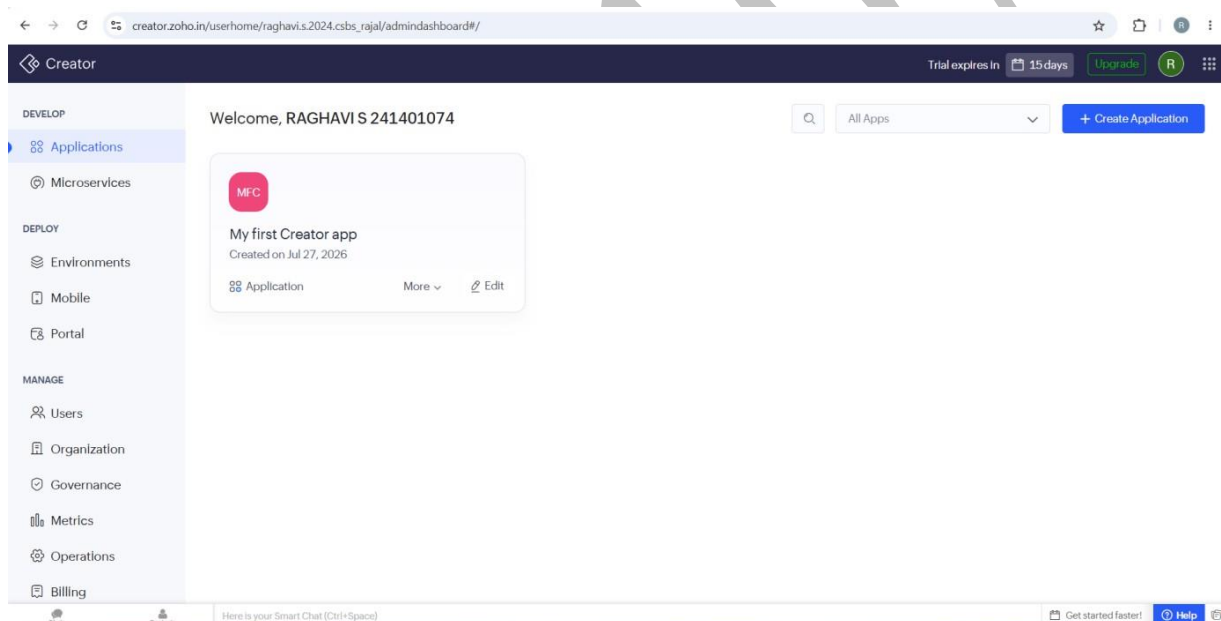
The screenshot shows the Zoho Creator account creation interface. At the top, there are logos for Zoho and Google. Below them, a green circular profile icon with the letter 'R' is displayed next to the text "Welcome RAGHAVI S 241401074!". A message states: "A new Zoho account will be created for the email address raghavi.s.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in." The form contains three input fields: "First name" with the value "RAGHAVI S", "Last name" with the value "241401074", and "Mobile Number" with a dropdown set to "+91". Below these fields, a note says: "As your IP address indicates you're in India, your account will be stored in the INDIA data centre." There is a checkbox for "I agree to the Terms of service and Privacy policies of Zoho Corporation". A blue "Create account" button is present. Below this, an "Or" separator is shown. The "Link existing accounts" section includes the text "If you have a Zoho account, you can link your Google account with it." and a "Link Accounts" button.

### 3. Dashboard Overview

After logging in, the Zoho Creator dashboard became the main place to manage the applications and settings. It showed details like the user profile, remaining trial period, and different options for creating and managing applications. A default application called “**My First Creator App**” was already available, which made it easier to understand how the platform works. The dashboard was simple and well-organised, so it was easy to explore even as a beginner.

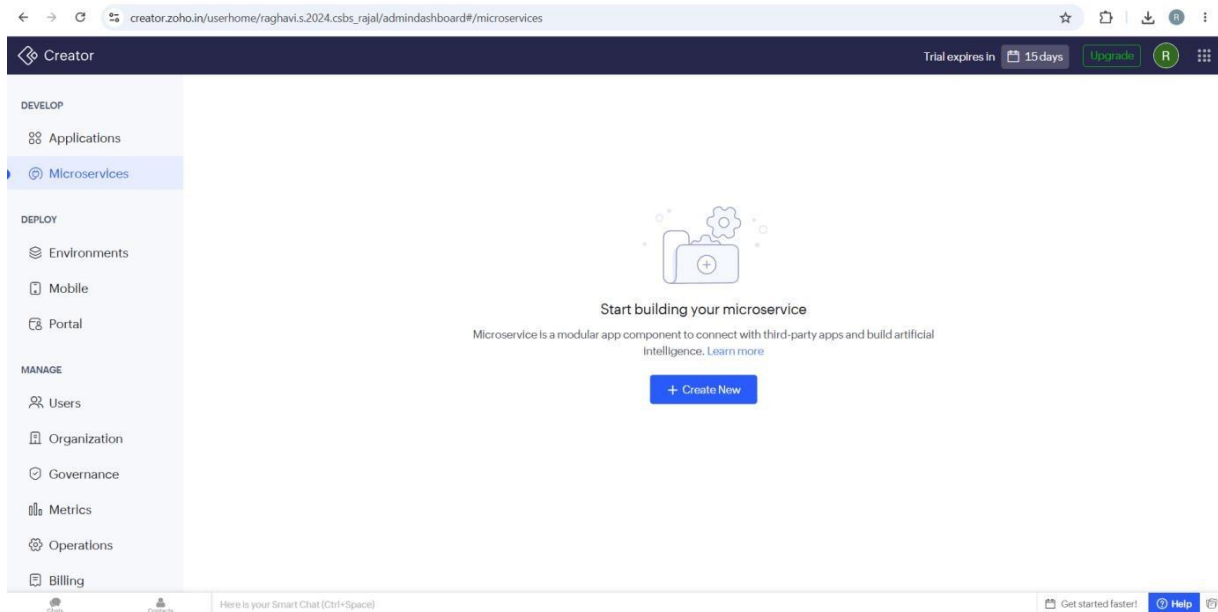
### 4. Applications Module

The **Applications** module is basically the main area where we can create and manage applications in Zoho Creator. It allows us to create new applications, make changes to existing ones, and keep all the projects in one place. While exploring, the default application was already visible, along with options to edit it and check its settings. This made it easier to understand how applications are organised and managed in Zoho Creator.



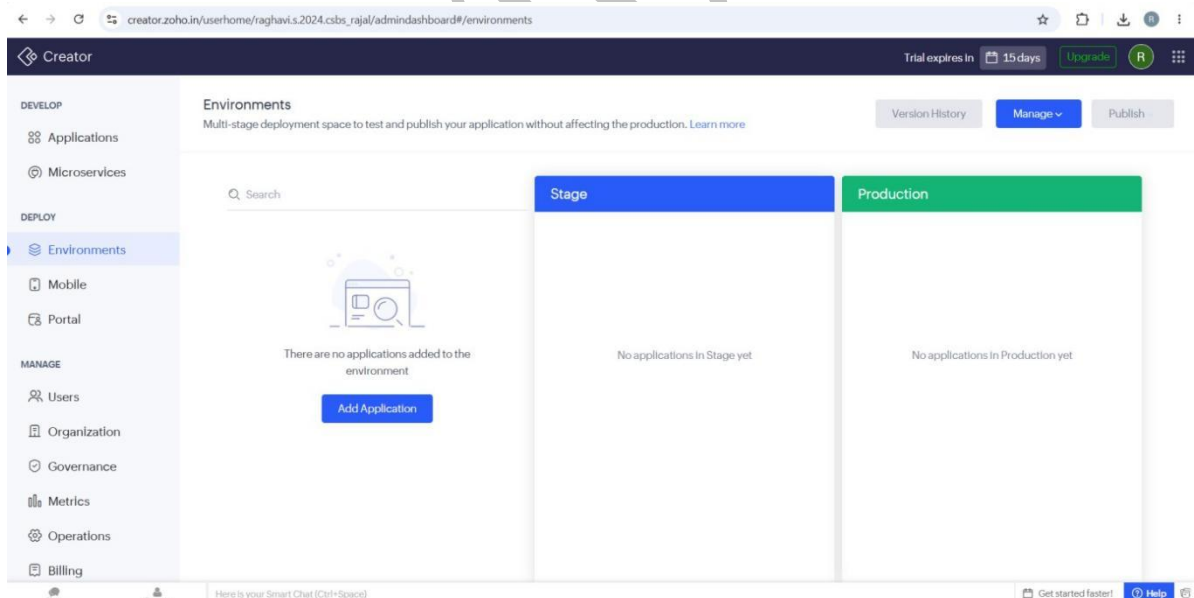
### 5. Microservices Module

The **Microservices** section is used to create small, separate services that can communicate with other applications through APIs. Although no microservices were created during the exploration, the section showed options for connecting with external applications and AI services. This feature can be useful when different applications need to share data or work together as part of a larger system.



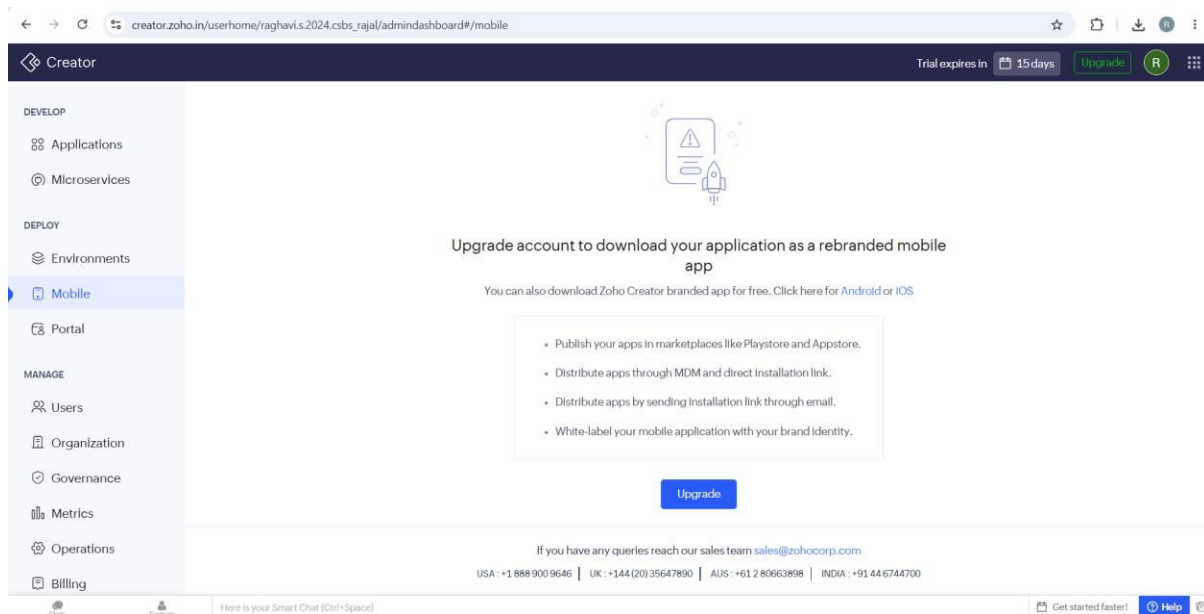
## 6. Environments Module

The **Environments** module helps developers manage applications through different stages: Development, Stage, and Production. This allows an application to be created and tested first before it is released to users. During the exploration, no application had been deployed, but the module showed how Zoho Creator keeps testing and the final version separate. This can help prevent errors and make the application more reliable.



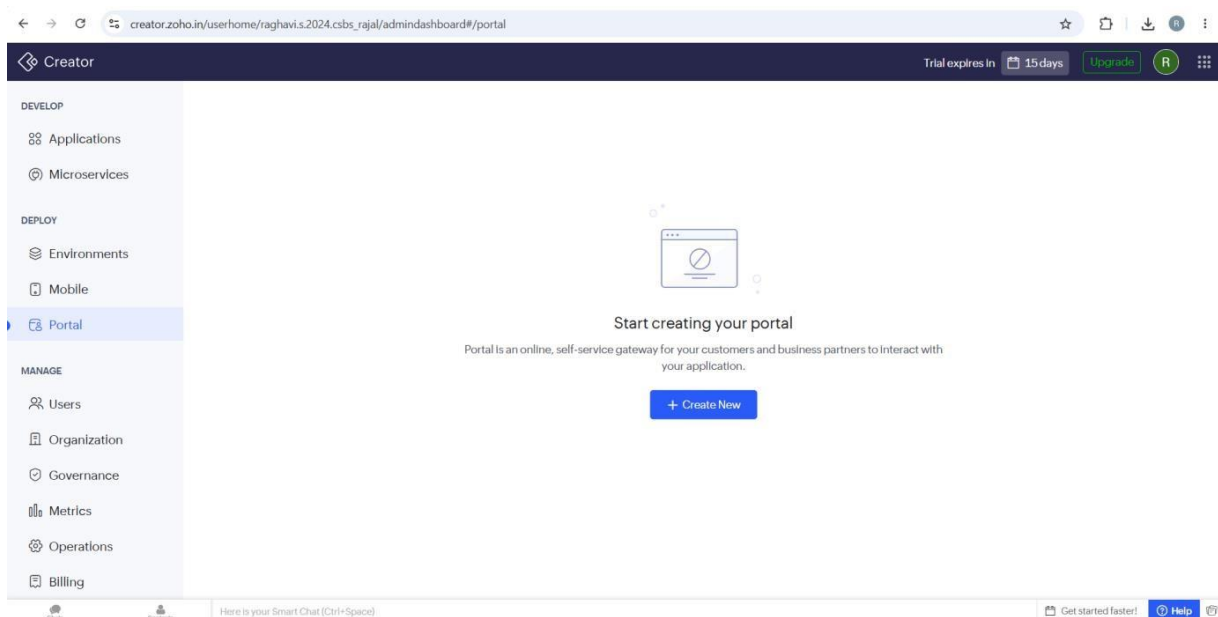
## 7. Mobile Module

The **Mobile** section shows that Zoho Creator can turn web applications into mobile apps as well. While exploring this section, it was found that features such as publishing apps for Android and iOS, adding custom branding, and distributing the apps are available with a paid plan. Overall, this feature makes it easier to create applications for both web and mobile using the same project.



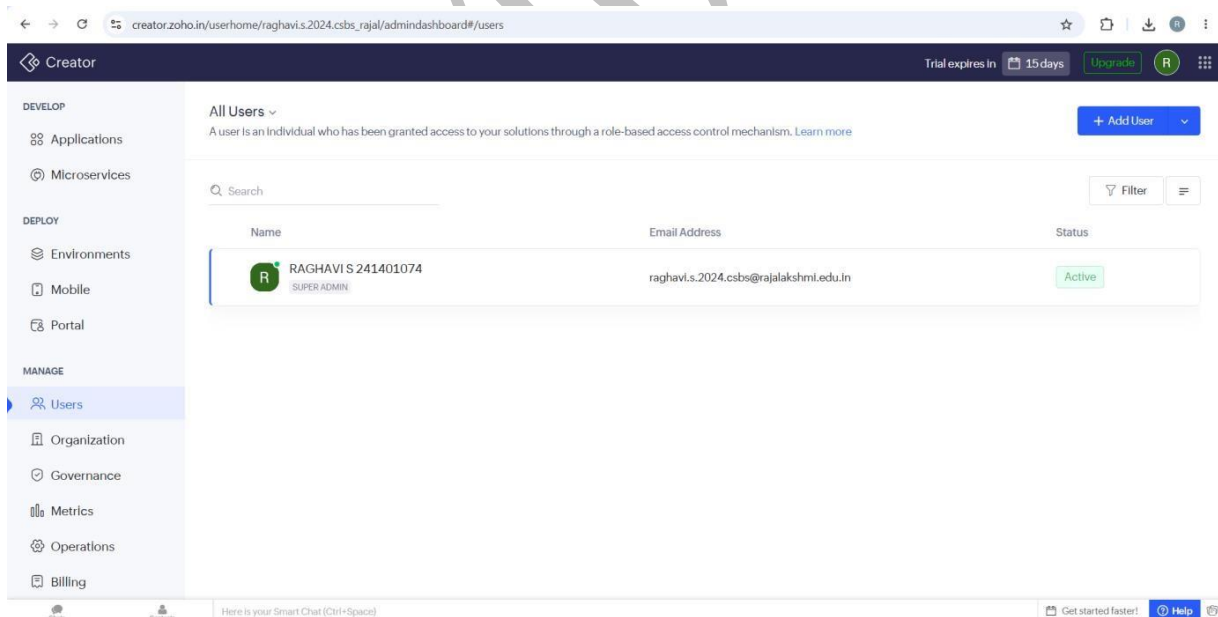
## 8. Portal Module

The **Portal** module can be used to create a separate web portal for customers, employees, or business partners. It allows people outside the organisation to access only the parts of the application they are allowed to use. We did not create a portal during the exploration, but the available options gave a clear idea of how this feature can be used while still keeping the application secure.



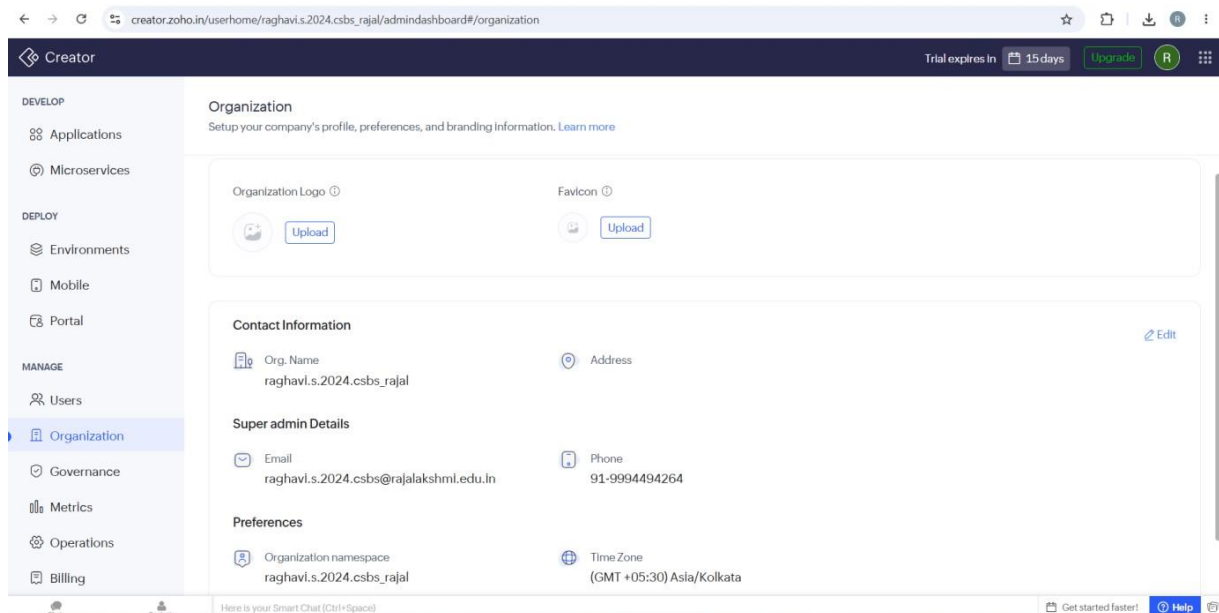
## 9.Users Module

The **Users** section is used to manage the people who have access to the applications. During the exploration, the registered account was shown as the Super Administrator and was active. There was also an option to add other users and set different access levels for them. This feature is useful when multiple people are working on the same application because each person can be given the appropriate access.



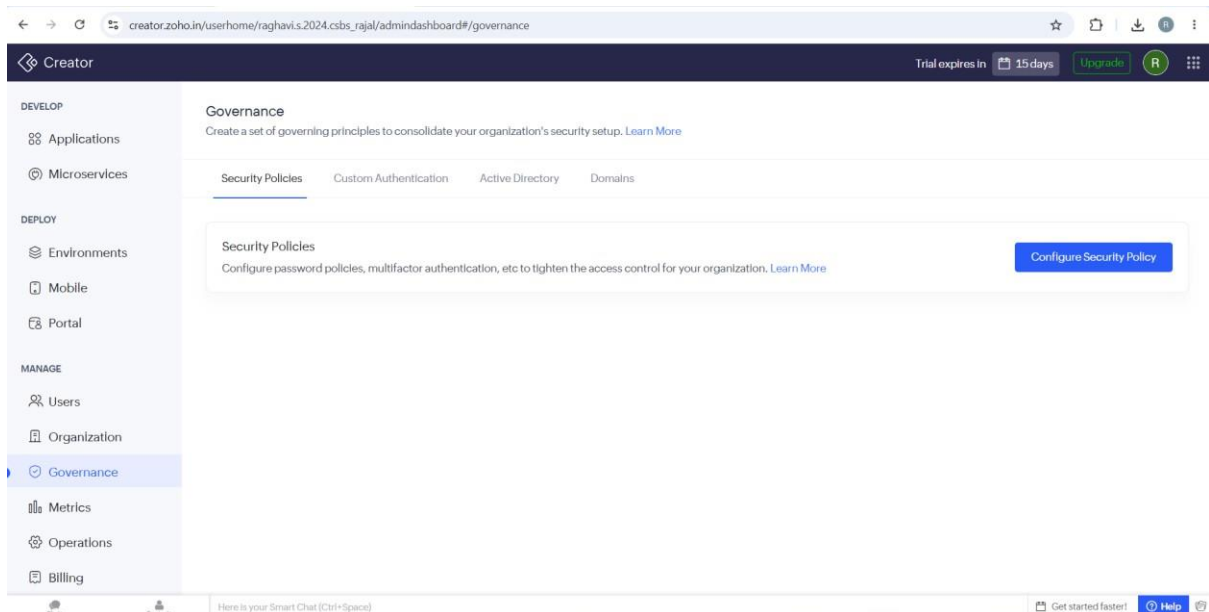
## 10. Organization Module

The **Organization** module is where we can manage the basic details of an organisation. It allows us to add the organisation's logo and favicon and also check details like contact information, administrator details, and time zone. These settings help give the applications a more personal and consistent look.



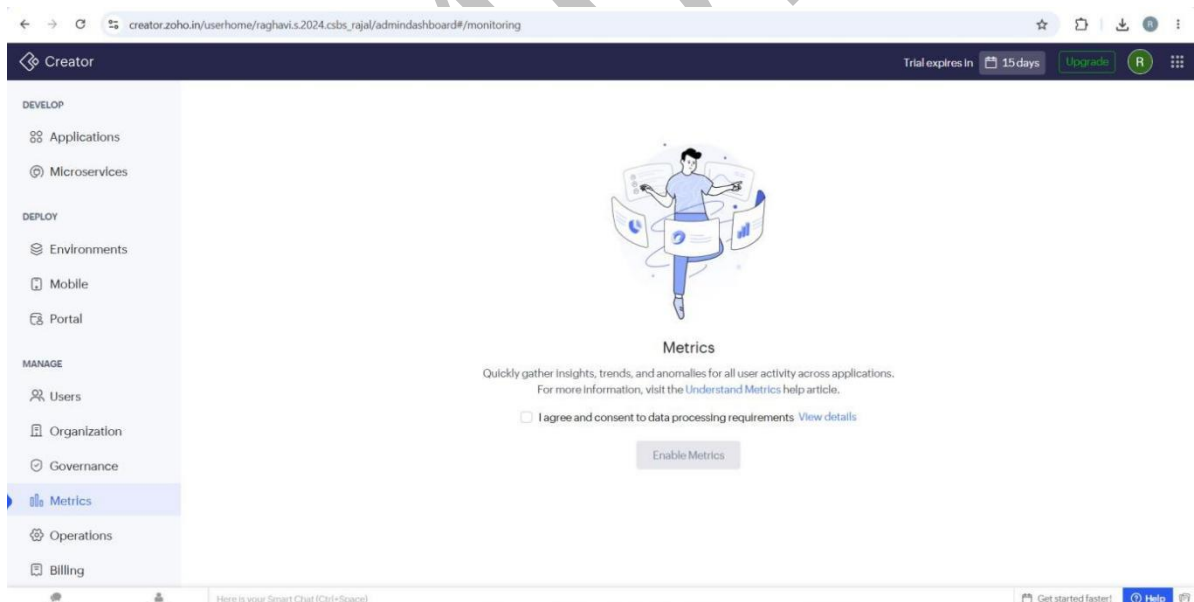
## 11. Governance Module

The **Governance** section is mainly used to manage the security of applications and control how users log in. It includes options such as password settings, multi-factor authentication, custom login methods, Active Directory, and domain management. We did not change any security settings during the exploration, but this section gave us a good idea of how Zoho Creator helps keep applications and user accounts secure.



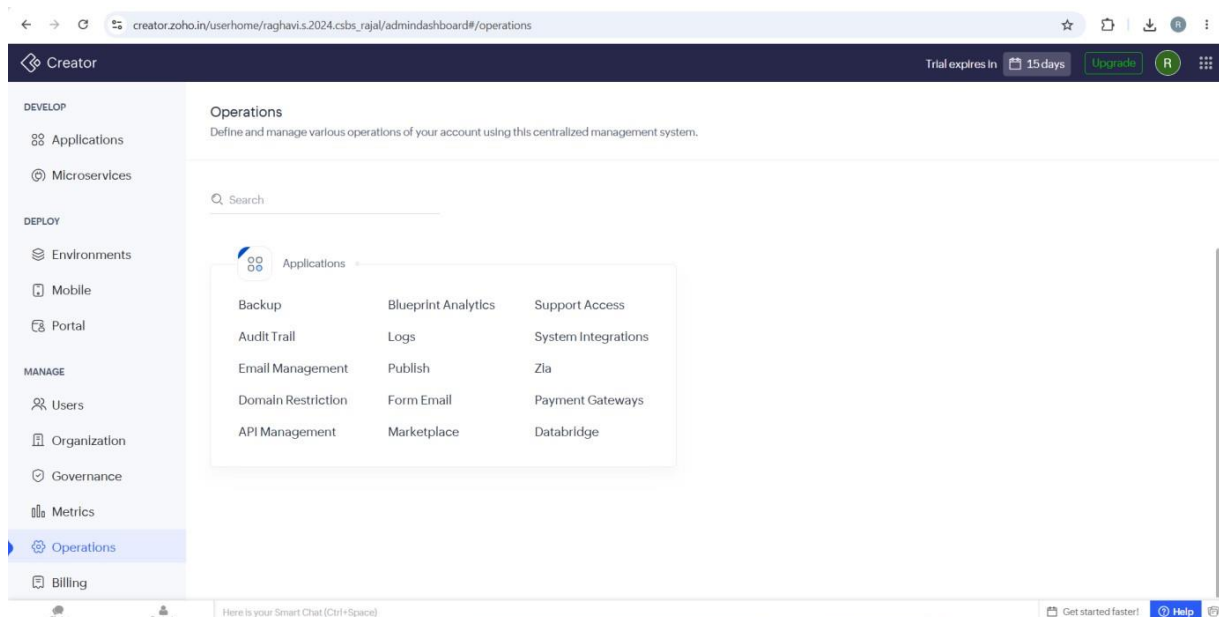
## 12. Metrics Module

The **Metrics** module helps us get an idea of how an application is being used and how well it is performing. It can be useful for checking usage patterns and noticing any unusual activity. While exploring it, we noticed that user permission was required before turning it on, which shows that Zoho Creator gives importance to privacy when collecting data.



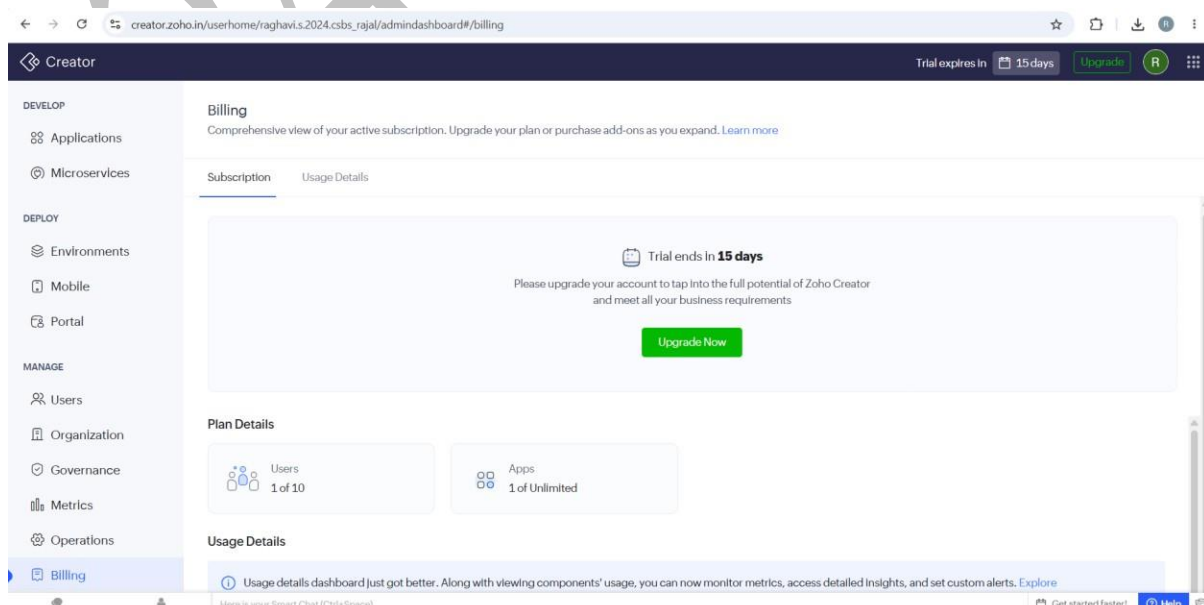
## 13. Operations Module

The **Operations** module is used to take care of an application once it has been developed. It brings together different tools for things like backups, checking logs, managing emails and APIs, connecting other services, handling payments, and publishing the application. Overall, it makes the day-to-day management of an application easier and more organised.



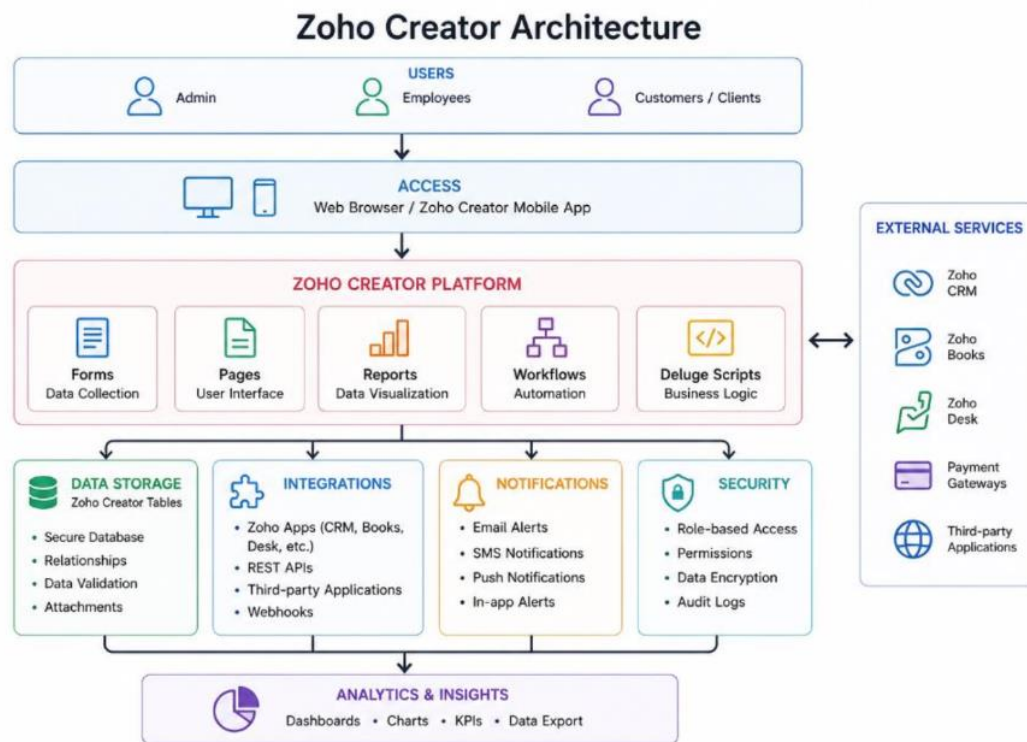
## 14. Billing Module

The **Billing** section is used to check the account's plan, trial period, and usage details. During the exploration, the account was on a 15-day free trial with one active user. It was helpful to see the subscription details and the different upgrade options available if more features are needed in the future.





# ZOHO CREATOR ARCHITECTURE



## Conclusion

Overall, the exploration of Zoho Creator helped us understand how a low-code platform can be used to build and manage applications. Its simple interface and different features for development, deployment, security, and management make it useful for creating applications without writing a lot of code. The exploration also gave us a better idea of how the platform works and provided a good starting point for developing applications in the future.